



SIMATS ENGINEERING
CO2-ASSESSMENT TOOL-5
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Course Code: CSA1511

Slot: B

Course Name: CLOUD COMPUTING AND BIG DATA ANALYTICS

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Question 1

A company experiences unpredictable traffic spikes during seasonal sales. Explain how cloud auto-scaling and load balancing can handle this demand efficiently. How does this approach reduce downtime and improve user experience? What role do monitoring tools play in this setup? Relate your answer to a real-world e-commerce scenario.

Answer

Introduction

During seasonal sales such as Black Friday or festival offers, an e-commerce website may receive millions of users within a short time. Cloud computing uses auto-scaling, load balancing, and monitoring tools to maintain application performance and availability.

Auto-Scaling

- Automatically increases the number of servers when traffic increases.
- Removes extra servers when traffic decreases.
- Prevents server overload.
- Optimizes cloud resource utilization.
- Reduces infrastructure costs.

Load Balancing

- Distributes incoming user requests across multiple servers.
- Prevents a single server from becoming overloaded.
- Improves application response time.

- Ensures high availability even if one server fails.
- Supports uninterrupted service during peak traffic.

Monitoring Tools

Monitoring services continuously track CPU usage, memory utilization, network traffic, and application health. When predefined thresholds are exceeded, they automatically trigger auto-scaling and notify administrators about system issues.

Real-World Example

Amazon experiences massive traffic during Prime Day sales. AWS Auto Scaling automatically launches additional virtual machines, while Elastic Load Balancer distributes customer requests evenly. CloudWatch continuously monitors system performance, ensuring customers experience fast page loading and uninterrupted shopping.

Conclusion

Cloud auto-scaling, load balancing, and monitoring work together to reduce downtime, improve user experience, optimize resource utilization, and maintain business continuity during unpredictable traffic spikes.

Question 2

An organization wants to store large volumes of backup data securely in the cloud. Discuss how cloud storage solutions ensure durability and data redundancy. How can encryption and access control protect sensitive backup data? Explain the cost advantages compared to traditional storage systems. Provide an example of a disaster recovery use case.

Answer

Introduction

Cloud storage provides a reliable and secure platform for storing large amounts of backup data. It ensures data durability through redundancy while protecting sensitive information using encryption and access control mechanisms.

Data Durability and Redundancy

- Data is stored across multiple servers and data centers.
- Automatic replication prevents data loss.
- Multiple copies remain available even if one server fails.
- High availability ensures continuous access.

- Regular integrity checks maintain data accuracy.

Encryption and Access Control

- Data is encrypted during transmission and while stored.
- Only authorized users can access backup files.
- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) improves account security.
- Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) limits permissions.
- Audit logs monitor user activities.

Cost Advantages

- No need to purchase expensive storage hardware.
- Pay only for storage used.
- Reduced maintenance and electricity costs.
- Automatic scalability eliminates unnecessary expenses.
- Lower operational costs compared to traditional storage.

Disaster Recovery Example

A company's primary data center is damaged due to flooding. Backup data stored in the cloud is restored to a new server, allowing business operations to continue with minimal downtime.

Conclusion

Cloud storage provides secure, scalable, and cost-effective backup solutions while ensuring high durability, strong security, and efficient disaster recovery.

Question 3

A mobile app company plans to deploy its application globally. Explain how Content Delivery Networks (CDNs) improve performance and reduce latency. How do edge servers enhance user experience across regions? Discuss how cloud providers support global availability. Relate this to a real-time streaming or gaming application.

Answer

Introduction

A Content Delivery Network (CDN) is a distributed network of servers that delivers content from locations closest to users. This reduces latency and improves application performance worldwide.

CDN Performance

- Stores frequently accessed content closer to users.
- Reduces network congestion.
- Decreases response time.
- Improves website and application speed.
- Handles large numbers of simultaneous users.

Edge Servers

- Located in different geographical regions.
- Deliver data from the nearest server.
- Reduce transmission delay.
- Improve streaming quality.
- Provide faster application response.

Global Availability

Cloud providers maintain data centers around the world. Applications are automatically routed to healthy regions if one location experiences failure, ensuring continuous availability.

Real-World Example

Netflix uses CDNs to deliver movies from nearby edge servers, reducing buffering and improving video quality. Online multiplayer games also use edge servers to reduce latency and provide smoother gameplay.

Conclusion

CDNs and edge servers improve application speed, reduce latency, enhance user experience, and provide reliable global availability for cloud applications.

Question 4

A financial institution requires strict compliance and data security in cloud usage. Explain how cloud providers support regulatory compliance and auditing. What role do logging, monitoring, and encryption play in security? How can the company ensure data sovereignty requirements are met? Give an example involving

sensitive financial transactions.

Answer

Introduction

Financial institutions handle highly sensitive customer information and must comply with regulatory requirements. Cloud providers offer security features that help organizations maintain compliance while protecting financial data.

Regulatory Compliance

- Support industry standards and regulatory frameworks.
- Maintain compliance documentation.
- Provide regular security assessments.
- Enable audit reporting.
- Offer certified cloud infrastructure.

Logging and Monitoring

- Record all user activities.
- Detect suspicious behavior.
- Generate security alerts.
- Assist during security investigations.
- Support compliance audits.

Encryption

- Encrypts stored data.
- Protects data during transmission.
- Prevents unauthorized access.
- Secures confidential customer information.
- Supports secure key management.

Data Sovereignty

Organizations can choose cloud regions where data is stored to comply with local laws requiring customer information

to remain within a specific country.

Example

A bank processes online fund transfers using encrypted communication, continuous monitoring, audit logs, and region-specific cloud storage to ensure secure transactions and regulatory compliance.

Conclusion

Cloud security features such as compliance support, logging, monitoring, encryption, and regional data storage help financial institutions protect customer information and satisfy legal requirements.

Question 5

A development team wants to adopt containerization for application deployment. Explain how containers differ from virtual machines in terms of performance and resource usage. How does orchestration (like Kubernetes) simplify deployment and scaling? Discuss portability benefits across different cloud environments. Provide an example of a microservices-based application.

Answer

Introduction

Containerization packages applications with all required dependencies, allowing them to run consistently across different environments. Containers are lightweight and more efficient than traditional virtual machines.

Containers vs Virtual Machines

Containers

- Share the host operating system.
- Start within seconds.
- Consume fewer resources.
- Higher application density.
- Faster deployment.

Virtual Machines

- Require a complete operating system.
- Consume more CPU and memory.
- Slower startup.

- Larger storage requirements.
- Better suited for full OS isolation.

Kubernetes Orchestration

- Automates container deployment.
- Performs automatic scaling.
- Balances application traffic.
- Restarts failed containers.
- Simplifies application management.

Portability

Containers run consistently across private, public, and hybrid cloud environments without changing application code, making migration easier.

Example

An online shopping application can be divided into separate microservices such as User Service, Product Service, Payment Service, and Order Service, with each service running in its own container and managed by Kubernetes.

Conclusion

Containers provide faster deployment, efficient resource usage, and excellent portability, while Kubernetes simplifies deployment, scaling, and management of cloud-native applications.